

Devam Dholakia

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EDUCATION

University of Central Florida

Orlando, FL

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, GPA: 3.93

Aug. 2024 – May 2028

- **Relevant Coursework:** Data Structures & Algorithms, Object-Oriented Software Development, Systems Software, Computer Logic & Organization, Discrete Structures I & II, Security in Computing

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineering Intern

May 2026 – Aug. 2026

USAA (United Services Automobile Association)

San Antonio, TX

- Cut a customer lookup from **4+ screens** to one view for service reps by fetching linked accounts on the server with **Spring Boot** and **React/Redux**.
- Shipped the lookup feature to production to lower **average handle time** on rep calls by owning it end to end, from data model and API design through rollout.
- Moved **6** legacy internal-service integrations off fragile REST response parsing by rebuilding them on a typed **GraphQL** API where callers request only the fields they need.

Research Assistant

Apr. 2026 – Present

Interactive Systems and User Experience (ISUE) Lab, UCF

Orlando, FL

- Built the related-work section for a **SIGGRAPH** submission on generating 3D scenes from text by reviewing and comparing methods across **65** papers.
- Automated scoring of NASA-TLX and SUS user surveys by fine-tuning **LLaMA** with **QLoRA** on consumer hardware and combining several weighted models to improve accuracy.

PROJECTS

uKnight | *Spring Boot, WebRTC, Next.js, PostgreSQL, Redis, Firebase, GCP Cloud Run, Docker*

- Led a **6-engineer team** to ship an anonymous video-chat app to **72** .edu users in **3 weeks**; ensured fair pairing with no double matches by designing a **Redis** queue with atomic **Lua** scripts.
- Kept peer-to-peer video latency under **100ms** with only **28–56ms** of call-setup delay by building **WebRTC** signaling over **STOMP/WebSockets** with a **SockJS** fallback.
- Made **GCP Cloud Run** servers fully interchangeable by moving session and match data from server memory into **Redis**, and secured every connection with .edu OTP verification and **Firebase** tokens.

Paradise – 3rd Place Overall, ShellHacks 2026 | *JavaScript, Node.js, WebRTC, YOLO, Gemini API, WebHID*

- Guided DeafBlind users to a Waymo and onto its door handle with no audio or screen by fusing **5** computer vision models across a phone and laptop into a **50ms** haptic loop on two **Joy-Cons**.
- Avoided false obstacle alarms by requiring a hit in **3 of 5** frames, running fast **YOLO** detection on the phone and streaming video over **WebRTC** to a heavier laptop model.
- Picked out the target Waymo among look-alike robotaxis at **~90%** recall with only **4** false positives in **654** negatives by training a **CLIP**-based classifier on **779** vehicle crops.

Apex: F1 Pit-Wall Simulator | *Next.js, FastAPI, WebSocket, XGBoost, NumPy*

- Predicted F1 lap times with **0.35s** average error (**0.996 R²**, 5-fold CV) and **0.64s** on an unseen Monza race by training a two-stage **Ridge** + **XGBoost** model.
- Delivered live strategy updates **120** times per second by running **10,000 NumPy** Monte Carlo simulations in **14ms** (p95) and streaming results from **FastAPI** to a **Next.js** dashboard over **WebSockets**.
- Helped the model generalize to new tracks by engineering **14** features from **10,244** laps across **11** Grands Prix and **22** drivers, and removing a base-pace feature that made it memorize circuits.

TECHNICAL SKILLS, AWARDS & LEADERSHIP

Languages: Java, Python, C, JavaScript (ES6+), SQL

Frameworks: Spring Boot, React, Next.js, Redux, Node.js (Express), FastAPI, GraphQL, WebRTC, WebSockets

ML & Data: XGBoost, scikit-learn, NumPy, pandas, PyTorch (QLoRA/PEFT)

Databases & Infrastructure: PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, GCP Cloud Run, AWS

Tools & Testing: Git/GitHub, GitHub Actions, JUnit | **Cert:** AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (CLF-C02)

Awards: KnightHacks 2025, 1st Place (Auritas Challenge) | ShellHacks 2026, 3rd Place Overall (300+ projects)

Leadership: Secretary, AI@UCF (450+ members), hosting technical workshops for student members